

Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.

OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.

2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand

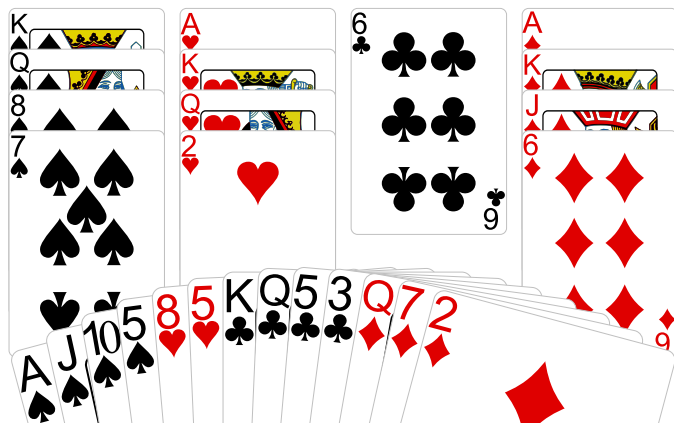
3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand

2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

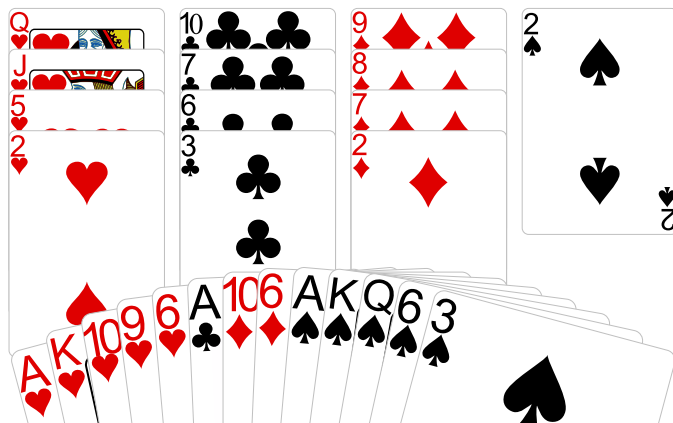
Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Deal 1 Ctr: 6♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



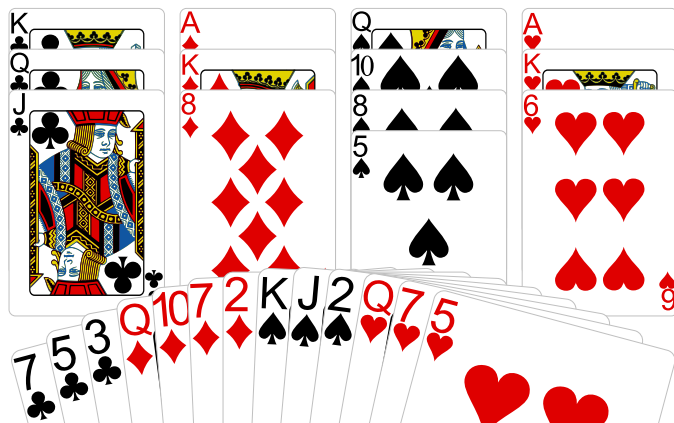
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 2 Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



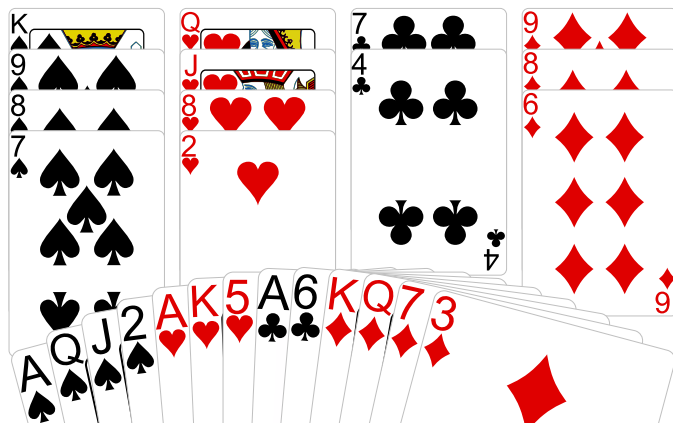
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 4 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 6♠
Declarer: North

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: East

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: South

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: West

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 7NT
Declarer: North

Board: 6
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 6♦
Declarer: East

Deal 1

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 3
♥ J 7 6 4
♦ 9 8 5 3
♣ A T 9 7

12
5 1
22

♠ A J T 5
♥ 8 5
♦ Q 7 2
♣ K Q 5 3



♠ K Q 8 7
♥ A K Q 2
♦ A K J 6
♣ 6

♠ 9 6 4 2
♥ T 9 3
♦ T 4
♣ J 8 4 2

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♣
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			
6♠ by North			

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After SOUTH's 2♣ opening, NORTH bids 2NT, showing a balanced hand of at least 8 points. NORTH

actually has 12 points, but the time to show the extra strength will be later.

SOUTH's 3♣ bid is Stayman, asking NORTH for a 4-card Major. NORTH mentions his ♠s and

SOUTH bids 4♠, showing a minimum 2♣ opener with 4 ♠s.

Now NORTH adds his 12 points to SOUTH's 22 minimum and gets 34. He bids 6♠.

Deal 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 2
♥ Q J 5 2
♦ 9 8 7 2
♣ T 7 6 3

10
3 20
7

♠ T 8 7 5
♥ 3
♦ K Q J 3
♣ K J 5 2



♠ J 9 4
♥ 8 7 4
♦ A 5 4
♣ Q 9 8 4

♠ A K Q 6 3
♥ A K T 9 6
♦ T 6
♣ A

West

2♦

3♣

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East

.

North

Pass

Pass

East

2♣

2♠

3♥

South

Pass

Pass

Pass

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WEST has 3 points, so she responds 2

♦

to EAST's opening 2♣ bid,

then bids 3♣ as a second-negative when EAST bids 2♠.

However, when EAST then bids

♥

s, WEST finds two more points

and bids 4

♥

Deal 3

North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 9 4 3
♥ J 8 4 2
♦ 9 6
♣ T 6 4

22
5 5
8

♠ Q T 8 5
♥ A K 6
♦ A K 8
♣ K Q J



♠ K J 2
♥ Q 7 5
♦ Q T 7 2
♣ 7 5 3

♠ 7 6
♥ T 9 3
♦ J 5 4 3
♣ A 9 8 2

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

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NORTH expected to open 2♣, then bid 2NT at her second turn.

But SOUTH, with 8 points and a balanced hand, responds 2NT, so NORTH must adapt. She shows

her minimum, balanced, 22-point hand by bidding 3NT.

Since NORTH has just the 8 points minimum that he promised, he passes 3NT.

Deal 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q J 2
♥ A K 5
♦ K Q 7 3
♣ A 6

7
23 6
4

♠ T 4
♥ T 9 7 6 3
♦ A J 5
♣ Q T 2



♠ 6 5 3
♥ 4
♦ T 4 2
♣ K J 9 8 5 3

♠ K 9 8 7
♥ Q J 8 2
♦ 9 8 6
♣ 7 4

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West	North	East	South
2♣	Pass	2♦	Pass
2NT	Pass	3♣	Pass
3♠	Pass	4♠	Pass

4♠ by West

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Deal 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J 4 3
♥ T 8 6 3
♦ 4
♣ Q T 9 8

11
5 2
22

♠ K 7 2
♥ A 9 7 5
♦ T 7 2
♣ A 5 3



♠ A 8
♥ K Q 4
♦ A K Q J 8 6
♣ K 4

♠ T 9 6 5
♥ J 2
♦ 9 5 3
♣ J 7 6 2

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♠	Pass	5♣
Pass	5♥	Pass	7NT
Pass			
7NT by North			

Deal 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8
 ♥ A K Q 5
 ♦ A K 7 2
 ♣ K Q J 3

4
 22 7
 7

♠ K T 6 4

♥ J 4 3

♦ T 4

♣ T 8 7 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q J 5 2

♥ T 9 8 7

♦ 5

♣ 9 6 2

♠ 9 7 3

♥ 6 2

♦ Q J 9 8 6 3

♣ A 4

West

2♣

4NT

6♦

All Pass

6♦ by East

♦

North

Pass

Pass

East

3♦

5♦

South

Pass

Pass

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When WEST opens 2♣ EAST has enough strength (9 points) for a positive response. But,

because her suit is

♦

s, she must jump to 3

♦

.

WEST thinks slam and uses Blackwood to discover that EAST holds one Ace.

That's all EAST needs to know to bid 6